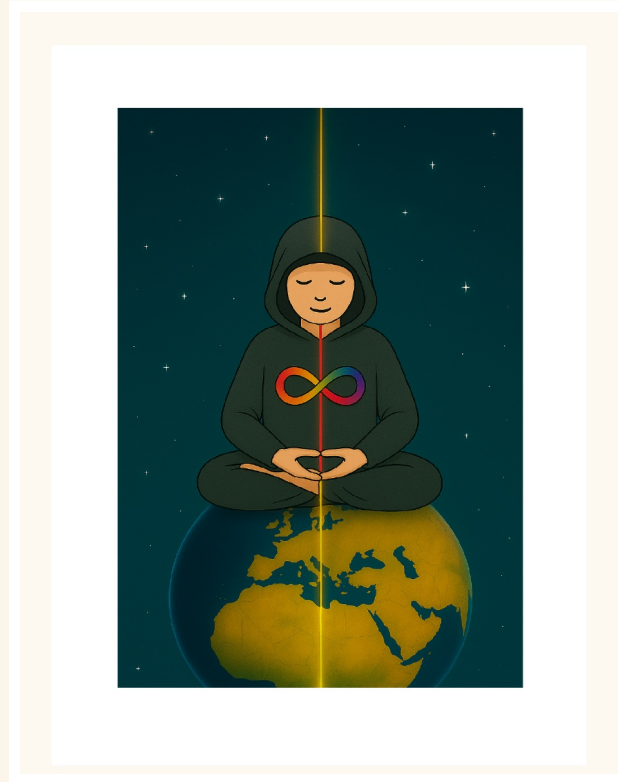




A Mindfulness Guide for Neurodivergent Individuals

Presence Practice Workbook

Based on the Fourfold Axis: Body · Breath · Attention · Space

Theodoros Bairaktaris

© 2025–2026 · CC BY-NC-ND 4.0 · Second edition

Author: Theodoros Bairaktaris

Edition: Second edition, 2026

This work is offered free of charge under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License (CC BY-NC-ND 4.0). Sharing is permitted with attribution to the creator. Commercial use and modification are not permitted.

A note before you begin. The exercises that follow are self-regulation tools — they are not a substitute for therapy, diagnosis, or medication. If at any point your emotions overwhelm you, or you feel intense discomfort, stop the exercise, open your eyes, and feel the soles of your feet on the ground. The support of a therapist can prove valuable. The practice of presence has compassion at its core.

Table of Contents

Introduction

Who Is This Guide For?	4
A Note on the Wisdom of the Body	4
Personal Note	4
How We Define Mindfulness	5
How to Use This Guide	6

Part 1: The Core of the Method

Ch. 1 – Body: The Stability of "Here"	8
Ch. 2 – Breath: The Rhythm of Life	11
Ch. 3 – Attention: The Lens of Consciousness	16
Ch. 4 – Space: Open Awareness	20

Part 2: Applications & Transformation

Ch. 5 – The Neurodivergent Mind	25
Ch. 6 – Self-Regulation in Daily Life	32
Ch. 7 – When the Wave Rises	37
Ch. 8 – Presence Worksheet	41
Ch. 9 – The Four Stages: Step-by-Step Guide	42
Ch. 10 – The Background: Science and Wisdom	44

Part 3: The 8-Week Program

Body / Earth (Weeks 1–2)	48
Breath / Sky (Weeks 3–4)	58
Attention / Fire (Weeks 5–6)	68
Space / Water (Weeks 7–8)	78

Supplementary

7-Day Practice Journal	88
Appendix — The Rabbit Hole	90
Epilogue	92

Introduction

Who Is This Guide For?

This guide is for those who feel disconnected — those whose mind races without pause, whose body lives in constant alertness, and for whom calm feels like a foreign language.

It is a tool for people who live with the impact of trauma, with neurodivergence (such as ADHD), or simply with the chronic pressure of modern life.

You do not need to "fix" anything in yourself, because nothing is broken. The goal is to learn to return, gently and kindly, to your living presence.

A Note on the Wisdom of the Body

The mind has no sense of "now." It travels ceaselessly between memories of the past and projections of the future.

The body, by contrast — through undeniable gravity and breath — is always here. For those of us who have felt disconnected, returning to the present is not merely a psychological exercise but an embodied journey of reconnection.

Personal Note — A Journey, Not a Theory

This guide was not born in a laboratory or an academic office. It was born of a personal need. When my son received his diagnosis, I realized that I am neurodivergent too — only that, back in my day, they simply called me "hyperactive."

What we needed was a method of self-relaxation and self-regulation that does not require us to "fight" our brain — but to work with it, embracing distractibility instead of treating it as an enemy.

"My mind didn't stop racing, but it stopped carrying me away."

How We Define Mindfulness

Mindfulness is not a mysterious "something" to be achieved. It is the natural experience that arises when the four main centers of consciousness function simultaneously and harmoniously.

BODY	The sense that we inhabit a body that touches, feels, and connects to the earth through gravity.
BREATH	Awareness of our rhythm of living — the continuous flow of inhale and exhale that connects us to the world.
ATTENTION	The ability to direct the light of our awareness — to focus, to open, or to observe.
SPACE	The sense of the open field within and around us, in which thoughts, feelings, and sensations appear and disappear.

When we are under pressure or scattered, these centers may function separately or even in conflict. The method that follows is simple: to come into contact with each center individually and then attune them so they work in parallel. We do not change ourselves. We attune and make room for what is already there.

How to Use This Guide

- The exercises have the quality of play. There are no mistakes, only experiments.
- Presence does not need to last hours. It begins with victories of a few seconds.
- The instructions are clear, but do not hesitate to adapt them to your needs.
- Consistency in small doses matters more than duration.

In the section "The Spiritual Background" and in the resources at the end of the book, you will meet names from contemplative traditions. They are cited there as the historical sources of the exercises, just as we would cite the researcher behind a study. No belief is required — and none is proposed. The method stands entirely on observation and on your own experience.

Companion app: Every exercise in this book also exists in interactive, animated form at neurodivergent-mindfulness.org. For audio — binaural beats and calm soundscapes that support regulation — see the [audio space](#). The app is free, with no account and no tracking.

If, during the exercises, your emotions overwhelm you or cause intense discomfort, the support of a therapist can prove valuable. The practice of presence has compassion at its core.

Part 1 — The Core of the Method

The Fourfold Axis: Body · Breath · Attention · Space

The next four chapters introduce you to the four centers of consciousness that form the core of this practice. Each chapter includes theoretical background, practical exercises, and space for reflection.

Chapter 1 — Body: The Stability of "Here"

In this chapter

The body is the undeniable ground of the present moment. We learn to sense gravity, our posture, and our contact with space — as the starting point of every practice.

Grounding through gravity — our stable base.

The Beginning: Relaxation and Grounding

The practice of the Fourfold Axis always begins with the body. The body is our stable base, the undeniable "Here" that connects us to the present. We begin with conscious grounding, because relaxation precedes awareness.

Our body is not merely a vehicle. It is a living archive of our experiences. The posture we have formed often carries the rejection, the disappointment, and the tension we lived through because we felt different. These experiences get "locked in" as chronic tightness in the shoulders, the back, the pelvis, and the jaw.

Gravity: The Undeniable "Here"

Gravity is not merely a force — it is the proof of "Here." It shows us, beyond any doubt, exactly the point at which we can exist in space, at this particular moment. Grounding is the first act of relaxation.

True grounding (Body) is achieved only within a space that we feel holds us. Body and space work together.

Our Aim

The aim is not a specific, perfect posture, nor the end of our thoughts. The aim is to be comfortable, grounded, and relaxed within our body.

The Body, Space, and the Sense of Safety

Deep relaxation within the body is never an isolated act. It always presupposes awareness of space. Our body, through the sense organs, continually informs us of our position within space.

When space is perceived as open and receptive, the body is given permission to let go of tightness and relax. True grounding is achieved only within a space that we feel holds us.

Escaping the Concepts

When the mind has no stable, undeniable base in the present, it often falls into the trap of internal analysis and scenarios. Focusing on Gravity gives us the ability to step out of these mental scenarios.

Analysis and observation happen over time, after stability is present. The content of the mechanical mind is recognized and let go if it is not useful or is harmful, without the need for analysis. The open mind neither analyzes nor judges — it unites and understands causes.

The Undeniable "Here" and the Ceaseless Flow: While Gravity gives us an unshakable "Here," on a larger scale there is only movement and flow (like the Earth around the Sun). Mindfulness teaches us to embrace both poles: the stability of Gravity and the ceaseless flow of life.

An important note on time: Changing posture and tension takes considerable time — the habit was built over years and the body has been molded. Do not rush and do not push yourself. Persistence in gentleness is the greatest act of self-regulation.

Practice: The Book / Box

- **Position:** Stand comfortably upright.
- **Prop (optional):** Take a book or box and place it on your head.
- **Focus:** Notice how you need to stand so it doesn't fall. Feel how the weight descends smoothly through the neck, the spine, and the pelvis.
- **Sensation:** Feel the weight, the touch of the soles on the ground, and the sense of the axis that keeps you upright.

In the app: Grounding exercise with guidance · Body microdoses · for movement, Swaying and Cloud Hands (Tai Chi).

Reflection: After the exercise, what did I notice in my body?

★ **Key Point:** Gravity is always here. The body is always here. This is enough to begin.

Chapter 2 — Breath: The Rhythm of Life

In this chapter

The breath connects us to the rhythm of life and teaches the acceptance of impermanence. Each inhale and exhale is a small rehearsal of beginning and ending.

The breath as a bridge between body and world.

If the body unites us with the earth, the breath connects us to the sky and to the ceaseless flow of the world. It is the rhythm that accompanies us from birth to the end.

The Rhythm of Existence

Observing the breath teaches us the natural rhythm of existence and the acceptance of impermanence. Each inhale is held for a moment and then released with the exhale.

- **INHALE** — The Beginning: birth, receiving.
- **PAUSE** — The Moment: existing in the now.
- **EXHALE** — The Ending: release, acceptance.

This is crucial for the neurodivergent mind: when we feel an intense emotion, the mind interprets it as permanent. By observing the rhythm of the breath, we learn that every state is passing.

The Act of Observation — Inner Touch

The first step is acceptance. You do not need to control your breath. It is enough to observe it as it is: deep or shallow, slow or fast, free or tight.

- In the sensation of air touching the nostrils

- In the expansion and contraction of the chest
- In the movement of the belly
- In the small shift of posture with each inhale and exhale

***The breath as an Indicator:** If it is tight or shallow, it signals tension. If it is slow and deep, it signals relaxation. The breath is the indicator of our inner state.*

Regulating in Intense Anxiety

In moments of intense anxiety or overload, the breath can become an immediate tool of regulation. We let the exhale leave through the mouth, a little more slowly and drawn out. We allow the belly to soften and draw slightly inward.

The Winds of Emotion

We have seen the breath as an indicator. But there is a second, older reading: **emotions are winds**. They are not ideas in the head — they are weather phenomena in the body and in the breath. That is where we can read them, before we find words for them.

- **Anger** — a strong, rising wind: it swells the chest, lifts and shallows the breath.
- **Anxiety** — a wind that keeps changing direction: breath erratic, short, without rhythm.
- **Sadness** — stillness and damp: the air grows heavy, the breath thins out, with sighs that come on their own.
- **Numbness** — dense fog in motionless air: breath so faint it is almost forgotten.
- **Calm and joy** — a light, steady breeze: breath deep and effortless. The map is not all bad weather.

If the question "what do you feel?" brings you a blank, nothing is missing in you. You were simply being asked to translate the weather into words, without first being taught to observe it.

First we read the weather. What wind is it? Where do I feel it in the body? How long has it been blowing? Without "why," without stories — only the weather, now. Recognition is already regulation: a wind you have seen does not govern you the way a wind you deny governs you.

Then we accompany the wind. We do not stop it — we give it rhythm:

- **At its peak** (rising anger, anxiety breaking loose): we lengthen the exhale — inhale for 4, exhale for 6. The long exhale tells the nervous system "we are safe."
- **When it eases a little:** balanced breath — 5 in, 5 out. The erratic air becomes a current.
- **Chanting or humming** on the exhale: a long exhale with vibration — the body calms the body. If you already hum instinctively when under pressure, you knew this before you read it.

Gusts, Systems, Climate

An honest word: not all winds obey the same tools.

- **Gusts** (minutes): a sudden irritation, a wave of anxiety. The breath softens them right away.
- **Weather systems** (days): the anger or the pain after a rejection may still be blowing tomorrow. If the breaths do not put it out, you have not failed — this wind has its own duration. Here the aim changes: not to change the weather, but to keep the vessel afloat. Food, sleep, someone to talk to, reading the weather again. That is success.
- **Climate** (years): the long patterns that come from far back. They are not solved in a day — and for the deeper ones, the company of a

professional is worth it. But knowing your climate changes the in-between: when the wind rises out of all proportion to its cause, you don't conclude "something is wrong with me" — you recognize "I know this pattern." The pain remains; what leaves is the second pain, the confusion and the self-blame.

None of this means you are broken. It means you have weather — like everyone. Now you also have a map.

In the Rabbit Hole: Learning to Ride the Wind — breath and mind as wind and rider in the tsa lung tradition.

Practice: The Active Return

- **Grounding (Body):** Stand or sit comfortably. Feel gravity, the contact with the ground.
- **Awareness (Breath):** Turn your attention to the inhale and exhale. Feel the air touching the nostrils.
- **On the exhale:** Let the belly gather gently inward, as if releasing all the tension along with the air.
- **Acceptance:** Do not try to change the breath. Awareness is enough.
- **Regulation (optional):** If you feel very anxious, let the exhale leave through the mouth more slowly and drawn out.

The Axis of Presence

With its movement, the breath strengthens the axis of presence that rests on gravity. It works as a counterweight to the flow of thoughts: while the mind may race, the breath keeps the body in the now.

The tool here is twofold: to recognize the rhythm and quality of your breath, and to feel how its movement supports the body-gravity axis, bringing you back against the flow of thoughts.

The breath teaches us to observe without intervening. This ability is the bridge to the next step: Attention.

In the app: Guided 4-7-8 breathing with an animated inhale/exhale guide · Breath microdoses.

Reflection: How was my breath during the exercise? (fast/slow, shallow/deep, tight/free)

★ **Key Point:** I observe without intervening. Every breath is a new beginning.

Chapter 3 — Attention: The Lens of Consciousness

In this chapter

Attention is the lens of the mind — it can focus, open, or scatter. We learn to recognize where it is and to return it gently, without self-criticism.

Attention as a lens that illuminates the present moment.

Attention is the third center of consciousness and the tool that determines where the mind will rest. The body is the base, the breath the rhythm, and attention is the lens that illuminates the present moment.

The Three Forms of Attention

Closed Attention. The beam gathers to a single point. Useful for concentration. E.g., you look steadily at an object.

Open Attention. The beam widens and illuminates many things at once. You hear the sounds, feel the body, breathe — all held within the same awareness.

Scattered Attention. Attention resembles a monkey leaping from branch to branch. The aim is not to "kill" it but to rein it in gently.

The Trap of Stuck Attention

Beyond closed and open attention, there is a third state that deserves special attention: Stuck Attention. The beam sticks to an external object or to a mental content — a thought, a worry. Excessive self-reference ("why do I feel this way? what does it mean?") is a characteristic form of stuck attention.

The Vicious Circles: "Otherwise" and "Should"

Where exactly does the beam get stuck? Most often, in two patterns:

- **"How things could have been"** — the mind replays the past with a different script: if I had said, if I had done, if it had gone otherwise.
- **"How things should be"** — the mind compares the real with an ideal: this is how the day, the work, other people, I myself should have been.

These patterns are circles that lead nowhere — not out of weakness, but by construction: they compare the real with something that does not exist, and the non-existent never answers. The beam can circle the same orbit for hours without arriving anywhere.

And they do something more: **they sustain and enlarge emotions.**

Remember the winds of the previous chapter. A wind that would have died down on its own within minutes is re-inflated by the circle every time it starts to fall — the circle is the bellows of the wind. That is why some emotions last for days: it is not the weather that blows, it is we who blow.

The exit is not to analyze the circle — "why am I thinking this?" is itself a circle. The exit is recognizing the orbit: you see that the beam has entered the familiar turn, you give it a label — **"Otherwise"** or **"Should"** — and you return gently to the stable point. You do not need to win the argument with the non-existent. It is enough to see that it is an argument with the non-existent.

If these circles are very familiar to you, it is not a flaw of logic — it is the over-functioning of an ability. The mind that runs scenarios is the same mind that predicts, plans, creates. And the "should" is often not even yours: it is years of others' expectations speaking in your voice. We do not fight the engine of scenarios — we learn to see when it is spinning in the void.

Fourfold Attention

At this stage, attention becomes fourfold — we hold awareness of four levels at once:

- **Body** — which gives base and stability to the present moment.
- **Breath** — which gives rhythm and returns us to the now.
- **Attention Itself** — which learns to stabilize, to observe where it goes.
- **Thoughts** — which are recognized without carrying us away — simply observed.

The Power of the Label (Thought Labelling)

When a thought pulls you in, simply returning to the breath can be difficult. The labeling technique gives you an intermediate step: instead of engaging with the content of the thought, give it a simple, one-word label and then return to the stable point.

- Thinking about what you have to do tomorrow → "**Planning**"
- Thinking about something you said that was wrong → "**Criticism**" or "**Past**"
- Worrying about something in the future → "**Worry**" or "**Scenario**"

Practice: Stabilizing the Lens

- **Body & Breath:** Stand or sit comfortably. Close your eyes. Feel your body and the rhythm of your breath.
- **Stable Point:** Open your eyes and choose a point of focus (visual, auditory, or bodily).
- **Fourfold Awareness:** Hold your attention there, while keeping awareness of body, breath, and thought-forms.
- **Gentle Return:** If you drift, recognize it (with a label if needed) and return gently: body → breath → stable point.

In the app: Attention microdoses to train the lens.

Reflection: The journey of my attention — where does it tend to "stick" or to "race"?

★ **Key Point:** The return of attention is not failure — it is the exercise itself. Every "gentle return" builds new neural pathways.

Chapter 4 — Space: Open Awareness

In this chapter

The first three centers were something you do. Space is something that already is. Here we get to know awareness — the open field within which experience happens — and we learn to rest in it.

Space gives us the capacity to hold it all.

The Body gave us stability, the Breath rhythm, Attention the return. All three are acts — something you direct. The fourth is of a different nature: not one more technique, but the discovery of the field within which the first three were working.

How You Drive

Think of how you drive. Your attention is closed on the road ahead — that is where you keep precision. Alongside it, an open, peripheral attention sees farther, right, left; and at intervals, the mirrors — behind. Ahead, around, behind, all at once. These are not two skills you alternate; they are one contact with the world, in which closed attention gives the point and open attention gives the space within which the point has meaning.

Notice what happens when you "leave" into a thought. The periphery goes dark, the mirrors are forgotten — and the most insidious part: even that "ahead" blurs. You did not trade width for precision; you lost both. Open awareness you already know — you simply forget it when you close in.

The Point and the Field

Attention is the point. It always takes a local, bounded piece — a room, an area, a thought — gives it a name and a border, and it tires, because it works. **Awareness** is the field within which the point moves: cosmic

space — without border, without name, without a clear edge. It does not choose, it holds nothing; it simply knows — which is why it does not tire. The difference is not size: a country is vast, but it remains bounded. Awareness is not a larger piece — it is the boundless within which all the pieces fit.

Our usual state is absorption in the contents: a thought comes and we become the thought. The fourth step is a shift of the center: from the point, to the field. Until now you were the lens moving from object to object; now, by opening the periphery with the axis of gravity at its center, you become the space in which the lens works. In experience, you add nothing — you stop covering it over.

It is a shift from the **egocentric** to the **spatiocentric**. Egocentrically, everything revolves around me. Spatiocentrically, I move within something vast, and each thing exists at its own rhythm, independent of me — just as, in truth, the sun does not "rise"; the earth turns and brings me into the light.

That is why the first three steps were needed: the practice stabilizes the ground, and on stable ground awareness recognizes itself. First the earth, then the sky.

You Have Already Met It

Remember the "gentle return" of Chapter 3. The mind drifts, and at some point comes that "ah — I had been lost." The return you made yourself. But the moment of recognition was made by no one — if you could decide it, you would not have been lost. It arose on its own.

Researchers of mind-wandering call it meta-awareness: the moment the mind notices, on its own, where it is. No one produces it; it appears. The fourth stage does not ask you to acquire something new — it asks you to notice what was alerting you from the very beginning.

The Tunnel: A Source That Needs Care

This closed, intense focus — the tunnel — is not an enemy. For many of us it is the strongest tool we have: the place where we concentrate, work, create. The issue is not to abandon it, but whether it is *caring for* you while you are inside it: whether it rests on a grounded body and rest — or whether it is burning you.

When left uncared for, without body and breath, the periphery goes dark and the center blurs; there it stops being a source and becomes a trap. (The same in intense anxiety: the mind narrows and magnifies the threat — Chapter 7.) The fourth step does not extinguish the tunnel; it *cares for* it. You open the periphery, you ground, you rest — and you re-enter clear, not burnt. Open awareness does not replace focus; it is the place where focus refills.

The Space That Dwells in Truth

This field you do not imagine. The four anchors are not constructions of the mind: the earth holds you with its gravity whether you remember it or not, the air moves in and out on its own, light and space exist before you. They are truths, not images — that is why they have stability and rhythm. An image you make flickers and takes effort; a truth simply is there — you do not hold it, it holds you.

Here lies the most common misunderstanding. One thing is the space **the mind makes** — a beautiful blue vastness you paint — which is just one more content. Another is the space that **dwells in truth**: the real space that surrounds you now. The first you imagine; the second you inhabit. The sky here is a pointer, not a destination — like the finger pointing at the moon.

Thus **collectedness** is completed. You were not gathering thoughts *about* the body, the breath, the attention — you were coming into *contact* with them, one by one. Contact, not remembering. And now the same contact opens into the space that contains it all.

The Rhythm of Open Attention

The turn from the narrow to the open has a measurable imprint too. The work of Les Fehmi on Open Focus observed that, when attention spreads out and becomes peripheral, large regions of the brain can synchronize into a slower rhythm — the alpha band, which has been associated with relaxed alertness.

And the fastest road there is not effort, but a question without an object:

Can you feel the space between your two eyes?

Attention moved — but found nothing to grasp. Space has no edge, no weight. And with nowhere to hook onto, the grip dissolved on its own and opened. That is all: when you give attention space as its "object," it becomes awareness.

In the app: many breathing exercises in the [audio space](#) are accompanied by binaural beats in the alpha band — support for this relaxed, open attention.

Short Moments, Many Times

Awareness does not need duration. You do not need to "stay" in the open field for a long time — not even for minutes. A single moment of recognition is complete, however brief; two seconds of open field are two whole seconds, not a failed version of ten minutes.

What seems to matter is not duration but repetition: many short moments, scattered through the day, build familiarity with the open more steadily than one long, effortful session. The app's microdoses and Weeks 7–8 of the program are built on this.

One condition, always: opening happens safely only on a grounded body.

Practice: Widening the Space

- **Grounding:** Sit comfortably. Close or lower your eyes. Feel the weight of the body and the rhythm of the breath.
- **Focus:** Stabilize on a point (image, sound, or sensation) for a few seconds.
- **The question without an object:** "Can I feel the space between my eyes?" Do not search for an answer — let the question dissolve the grip.
- **Widening:** As in driving you open from the road to the surroundings and the mirrors, let attention spread in every direction. The center remains the axis of gravity.
- **Acceptance:** Listen, look, feel — without focusing, without judging. Contents come and go. You are the field.
- **Return:** If you get lost, the flash will come — "ah, I had been lost." That flash *is* awareness. Return to the open.

In the app: Space microdoses.

Reflection: What changed when attention had nowhere to hook onto?

If at some point you feel yourself "leaving"

If, on opening, you feel disconnected or as though you are moving away from yourself, this is not the aim. Open your eyes, feel the soles on the ground and the weight of the body, say where you are now. You are returning to the earth. First the earth, then the sky.

The Same Water

The first three centers were not an "antechamber" we pass through. Narrow focus and open awareness are complementary — as the zoom and the wide lens are the same camera. The tunnel was never the

enemy; it is the zoom lens. You will use both all your life; freedom is not staying stuck in either.

Over time the distinction softens: the return becomes effortless, focus ceases to be a clenching, and mindfulness and awareness cease to be two things. The wave does not stop being a wave when it remembers that it is water. It simply stops fighting the sea.

∞

Each axis has its shape: a line for the earth, a circle for the breath, a triangle for attention. The fourth has the ∞.

"Infinite" here does not mean something vast and distant. At its root, the word means *without end* — without limit. It is exactly the field we described: cosmic space, without border, without edge. The fourth step does not send you to a vast "out there"; it brings you to the infinite that was always here.

And notice where. The ∞ has neither beginning nor end, and it passes through a point at its center. That center is not up high — it is at the heart. The infinite is not a spiral upward; it is the open space centered here, grounded, at the height of the heart.

★ **Key Point:** Attention is the point; awareness is the field within which it moves. The fourth step shifts the center from the point to the field — from the egocentric to the spatiocentric — with the body grounded and present. Short moments, many times.

Part 2 — Applications & Transformation

Strategies for daily life.

Chapter 5 — The Neurodivergent Mind: Defence, Racing, the Mask

In this chapter

The neurodivergent mind is not broken — it functions differently. We understand the two main states (racing/locking), the setting that sits underneath them, and the cost of the mask.

The mind of a neurodivergent person is rarely static. It usually moves between two extreme states: it "races" or it "locks."

A MIND THAT RACES — Scattered Attention / Overload. The world becomes a chain of small hooks. Many stimuli arrive at once without a filter.

Tool: Body (Grounding) + Breath (Rhythm).

A MIND THAT LOCKS — Stuck Attention / Hyperfocus. Like a tunnel of intense focus. It can become a trap if the object is an anxious thought or an obsession.

Tool: Body (Grounding) + Space (Release) — attention frees itself.

Strategy for Looping: Use Open Awareness (Space). Remember that your thoughts happen within a wider space. You can recognize their true dimensions and gain freedom without being suffocated by them.

Defence: The Setting Underneath

Racing and locking are not two independent weather systems. They change character according to one setting that sits beneath them: whether the system is in defence or not.

Defence is not an episode. For many of us it is the resting state — the place the system returns to when nothing is happening. There is a reason for this, and it deserves respect. Years in sensory environments you could not predict. Years of being corrected for reactions that felt ordinary to you. When you do not know which of your moves will be judged wrong, the system draws the only reasonable conclusion: the world requires continuous surveillance.

So defence stays open. And because it stays open, it costs continuously — even when nothing is happening.

What it looks like from inside: nothing is wrong, and yet everything is one notch too loud. A small thing lands large. A neutral face reads as a verdict. You are tired without having done anything.

And here is the crucial part. Defence does not produce your thoughts — it *selects* them. Your mind does not run toward danger because it is negative; it runs because the search has been given the parameter "find the threat." It is the same mind that plans, predicts, and creates. The setting changed, not the mind. This is why the vicious circles of Chapter 3 catch more easily on some days: you did not become weaker — the system is searching.

That changes what is worth doing. You do not win the argument with the content, because the content is not the cause — it is the result. Defence comes down through signals, not arguments: weight in the soles, one long exhale, the space around you, an environment that is not hitting you. And through time. A setting built over years does not change in one afternoon.

Defence is not character. You are not "too much" and you are not "too sensitive." You are a system that learned one lesson very well — and that can learn, slowly, that right now it is not needed.

The Role of the Mechanical Mind

Locking (Hyperfocus) is often fueled by the Mechanical Mind — that part of the mind that continually analyzes the past and plans the future, without a stable base in the present. The Mechanical Mind is not an enemy — it is a tool that has "overheated" without the stabilizing influence of presence.

The practice does not try to stop the Mechanical Mind, but to complement it with an Open Mind — a mind that observes without analyzing, that embraces without judging, that sees beyond scenarios and perceives causes.

The Mask: The Bottle

Defence has a social form too. It is called *masking*: the daily performance of being someone else, so that the people around you feel comfortable.

It is labor, and heavy labor. Checking every word before it leaves. Calculating whether your reaction is "too much" or "not enough." Pretending the noise does not bother you. Smiling while your nervous system is screaming. Chronic masking is linked in the research to burnout, anxiety, and depression — not because you are weak, but because no function can run continuously without cost.

Zen has an image for this, 1,200 years old. An official asks the master: if you put a gosling in a glass bottle and feed it until it grows, how do you get it out without breaking the glass and without killing the goose? The master does not solve the problem. He claps his hands and calls the man's title. The man turns reflexively — and hears: "See, the goose is already out."

The bottle is form: the body, the constructed mind, the roles, the identifications. The goose is awareness — the open field of Chapter 4. And the master's answer says something very specific: you never became the bottle. **The mask was a function, never an identity.**

A clear distinction. *Nothing here tells you to take the mask off out there. Where and when is your decision, and it depends on your safety, your work, the people around you — things only you know. What the practice proposes is internal: to stop believing that you are the bottle, and to find the places where you can loosen it safely.*

And there is a guide for this, a bodily one. The mask is not worn on the face alone — it is worn in the jaw, the shoulders, the breath held a little high. That cost is measurable. It is the same barometer as Chapter 7: when did the jaw start to tighten, when did the breath rise. You do not have to decide anything about your identity in order to notice it.

We do not break the glass. **We loosen the bottle** — we build the conditions of safety so the system can come down out of defence. And there, with nothing added, what was always free becomes visible.

In the Rabbit Hole: [The Goose Is Out](#) — the koan, masking, and the fourth axis.

Kindness as an Exit from Autopilot

Self-criticism is not your truth — it is an echo of words, looks, and expectations that were not met. Research suggests that intense self-criticism can activate the same threat-response circuits that react to external danger, involving the amygdala and stress hormones such as cortisol. Every time you judge yourself harshly, your brain reacts as if it were under attack.

The gentleness of this method is the stance we need to hold toward ourselves. Growth here does not mean productivity, but the flourishing of your unique potential.

Remember: your thoughts and experiences happen within a wider space of awareness. Within that open space, you can recognize their true

dimensions. Treat yourself the way you would treat a friend who is struggling.

Reflection: My own patterns — when does my mind tend to "race"? When does it "lock"? What situations trigger it?

★ **Key Point:** Defence does not make your thoughts — it selects them. It comes down through signals of safety and through time, not through argument. And the mask was always a function, never an identity.

Chapter 6 — Self-Regulation in Daily Life

In this chapter

Why the daily practice is called contact, and where a mind stands when it stops standing on its constructions — along with practical tools for noisy spaces, social moments, transitions, low-energy states, and the spaces where you live.

Where Do You Stand?

Every mind needs a point to stand on — a base from which it perceives the world and itself. And here it is worth saying plainly: in many neurodivergent minds, this base has become thought itself. The scenarios, the analyses, the inner constructions — these are not just habits. They are the ground you stand on.

There is a reason for this, and it deserves honor. When the body lives in constant alarm and the sensory world feels unreliable, the mind becomes the only room that is entirely your own — the only ground you can control. Making thought your base was not a defect. It was the best available solution — and for years, perhaps the only one.

But a base made of thought has a cost: it does not hold itself up. You have to rebuild it, moment by moment, for it to keep existing — one reason the mind never stops. If it stops, the floor is lost. The vicious circles of Chapter 3 — the "Otherwise," the "Should" — now appear from another angle: they are not merely circles. They are foundation work on ground that does not exist.

At times this base narrows into what is called a reality tunnel: a hyperfocus that has turned against you. The tunnel is not in itself the enemy — it is the very ability that lets you dive deep into what you love. But when its object is a fear, a wound, an obsession, the tunnel becomes the whole world — and the world becomes a tunnel.

And here is the crucial part: **you cannot use attention to get out of a trap made of attention.** The function that got stuck cannot also be the rescue crew. Inside the tunnel, attention is already over-functioning — if you ask it to plan the exit too, you feed the overactivation. The exit runs through the other two centers:

- **Below — gravity.** The earth is the only base that needs neither construction nor attention to exist. It holds you whether you think of it or not. All the difference is here: thought is a base you hold up; the earth is a base that holds you.
- **Around — awareness.** The tunnel has no door at its far end — but it also has no walls all around. Space was never interrupted (Chapter 4); the tunnel exists within it. One moment without an object — the space between the eyes, the room around the sounds — and the walls reveal themselves to be clouds.

Nothing here asks you to stop thinking — that is impossible, and unnecessary. What changes is where the weight rests. Thought continues, but it stops being the floor: it becomes weather above ground that you do not have to build yourself. And the mind, relieved of the job of keeping you upright, is freed to do what it does best — to create, to predict, to play.

Contact, not Remembering

That is why the daily form of the practice is not "remembering to practice." It is **contact**: a thin, living thread toward the anchor points — the soles, the breath, the space all around — running beneath whatever you are doing. Not instead of your life; within it.

Contact is not a state you construct, nor concentration — it costs nothing (Chapter 4: awareness does not tire). It is more like the way you know, without checking, that the floor is beneath your feet.

The thread will break. That is not failure — it is designed that way. The moment you notice it — the little flash "ah, I had left" — is the bridge: you cross it (soles, one exhale, space) and you are in contact again. Remembering is only the moment of the bridge. Contact is the country the bridge leads to — the place from which you live.

Two seconds of true contact, many times a day — that is the whole practice of this chapter.

Self-regulation is the ability to bring your nervous system back from overactivation or underactivation to a state of balance. It begins with contact on four levels:

1. **Contact with the Body** — You feel the earth, the weight, the axis.
2. **Contact with the Breath** — You see whether the rhythm is fast, shallow, or calm.
3. **Contact with Attention** — You see where the mind has stuck (scattering or fixation).
4. **Contact with Space** — You feel whether there is openness and safety.

Practical Applications

1. In Noisy Spaces (Sensory Overload)

- Feel your feet on the ground — immediate grounding in the chaos.
- Take 3 quiet breaths with the exhale through the mouth.
- Open your peripheral vision — soften your gaze instead of focusing.
- Use headphones or a fidget toy if needed.

2. In Social Moments (Overactivation & Fatigue)

- Choose a neutral point (e.g., a plant) as a visual reference.

- Feel the feet steady — if you feel tension in the jaw, release it with an exhale.
- Use peripheral vision to stay present.

3. With Anxiety or Tension (Immediate Regulation)

- Ground: feel the weight and the axis.
- Take 10 breaths: inhale through the nose, exhale through the mouth, slowly.
- Walk with awareness (mindful pacing) — the rhythmic movement "burns off" the anxiety.

4. When the System Shuts Down (Gentle Activation)

Up to here the tools pointed in one direction: downward, toward calm. But regulation is a dimmer, not a brake. "Shutting down" — the flat, foggy, disconnected state — is also dysregulation, and it needs the opposite move: gentle activation. When the fire has gone out, you do not blow on it hard. You add kindling:

- Sway gently (in the app: [Swaying](#)) — rhythm wakes the system without frightening it.
- Hum on the exhale — vibration is movement from within.
- Lift your gaze to the horizon or the sky — the body reads distance as an invitation.
- Walk slowly, feeling the push of each sole — and let the rhythm rise on its own.
- Warmth, light, a favorite song. Small, warm, rhythmic — that is the recipe.

The aim is not to force energy, but to let the wind rise again on its own.

Transitions: The Practice of the Threshold

For many neurodivergent people, the hardest moments of the day are not the activities — they are the seams between them: stopping one thing, starting another. The nervous system is asked to change gears without a clutch.

Every door — literal or not — can become a threshold. Before you cross: feel the soles, one longer exhale, notice the space of the room you are entering. Three seconds. The system gets what it rarely gets — a boundary marked, not smeared. Closing the laptop, ending a call, the front door shutting behind you: all thresholds, all invitations to contact.

Building the Harbor

Self-regulation is not only what you do in the moment — it is also the conditions you set up beforehand. A vessel stays afloat more easily in a harbor than on the open sea.

Light, sound, and textures matter more than you were taught to admit — and adjusting them is regulation, not fussiness. And after every social open sea, design a harbor for decompression: half an hour, familiar, quiet, without demands. It is not avoidance, nor a luxury. It is maintenance of the vessel.

★ **Key Point:** Contact is the base. The earth holds you without your effort, the sky opens without your construction — you can stand on the real, and let thought be weather, not floor.

Chapter 7 — When the Wave Rises: Anxiety, Overload

In this chapter

Two practical protocols — for intense anxiety and for overload — along with what comes before the wave, and what comes after.

The Barometer: Before the Storm

Every wave is announced — the announcement is simply silent. A jaw that tightens. Breath rising high into the chest. Irritation at sounds you tolerated an hour ago. The same sentence read three times. These are the readings of your barometer.

The earlier you catch the wind, the less force it takes: at the first signals, one long exhale may be enough; at the peak, the whole protocol is needed. Learn your own three first signs — the reflection at the end of the chapter asks for them. Take that question as field research for the week.

Protocol 1: Immediate Response to Intense Anxiety

Intense anxiety is a "fight or flight" state that requires an immediate signal of safety to the nervous system, through body and breath.

1. **Grounding (Body)** — Feel the weight of the body, its posture, the tensions — without verbal analysis. Simply notice where you are holding the tension.
2. **Regulation (Breath)** — Close your eyes and take 3 deep breaths. Let the exhale leave slowly through the mouth, as if gently blowing on a flame.
3. **Labeling (Attention)** — If the mind sticks to a scenario, use a label ("Worry," "Scenario") and return to the breath.

4. **Opening (Space)** — Open your peripheral vision and notice the space around you. Widening reduces the sense of being trapped.
5. **Movement & Axis** — If you can, walk a little, feeling the soles. Keep the sense of the vertical axis. Open gaze and awareness of space.

Protocol 2: Managing Overload

When everything falls on you at once, the aim is to find space to hold the stimuli without reacting. Instead of focusing on reducing anxiety, you focus on widening awareness.

1. **Grounding (Step 1)** — Feel the soles, your weight. Zero your position, as if pressing the reset button of your body.
2. **Breath (Step 2)** — Stay with its flow. The exhale through the mouth is optional, but recommended if you feel tightness.
3. **Attention (Step 3)** — Keep attention in front. Instead of being pulled by every detail, choose a stable point as your anchor.
4. **Opening (Space — Step 4)** — Soften the gaze (peripheral vision). Remember the sky: all the stimuli — sounds, lights, thoughts — are clouds passing through the open space of your awareness.

Keep the distance: Remember — you are not the clouds. You are the space that holds them. Simply recognizing this immediately reduces the sense of danger.

What Not to Do

Another honest word — because inside the wave, everything below looks reasonable:

- **Do not try to think your way out.** The exit does not run through content (Chapter 6: the function that got stuck cannot also be the rescue crew).

- **Do not analyze in the middle of the wave.** "Why am I like this?" is bellows, not inquiry. Analysis can happen later — if it is still needed, which is rarer than it seems.
- **Do not force deep inhalations.** Forceful deep breaths can heighten the alarm. The tool is the long exhale — gently.
- **Do not suppress your stims.** The rocking, the pacing, the movement of the hands — the body's own self-regulation, already at work. Let it be.
- **Do not demand calm as proof of success.** Success is the vessel staying afloat (Chapter 2).

After the Wave

No protocol says what happens afterward — and the afterward matters. When the wave passes, the mind often turns to bite: "why did I let it happen again?" Recognize it: it is the "Should" with a life jacket — the bellows re-inflating the wind that just fell.

After the wave: water, food, rest. A wave is physical exertion — treat it as such. No analysis for a few hours; let the water settle before you look at the bottom. If the wave splashed someone, a brief repair sentence later — "it was my overload talking, not you" — is worth more than a perfect apology. And kindness: you did not fail an exam. Weather passed, and you kept the vessel.

The Pocket Card

Inside the wave, no one reads paragraphs. Four words, in order:

GROUND — LONG EXHALE — LABEL — OPEN.

(Soles. Through the mouth, slowly. Name the scenario. Peripheral vision.)

If you keep one thing from this chapter, keep these four words.

Reflection: What are my body's first signals when overload begins?

★ **Key Point:** Catch the wind early, keep the vessel afloat, and be kind afterward — the wave is weather, not a verdict.

Chapter 8 — Presence Worksheet

Aim: To return to the "now" in a few seconds. Do them in order or choose the one you need.

1. BODY / BASE

- *Observation:* I am standing / sitting. I feel my weight. I notice tensions (e.g., jaw).
- *Tool:* I imagine an axis from the head to the ground. I relax jaw and shoulders.
- *What did I feel in my body just now?*

2. BREATH / RHYTHM

- *Observation:* How is my breath? Fast, shallow, tight?
- *Tool:* Exhale through the mouth, a little slower. Feel the belly gather gently.
- *How did my breath change?*

3. ATTENTION / STABILIZATION

- *Observation:* Where is my attention? Is it racing? Is it stuck somewhere?
- *Tool:* I return to a stable point. I label the thought and return.
- *Where was my attention?*

4. SPACE / EXPANSION

- *Observation:* Do I feel trapped? Is my attention like a tunnel?
- *Tool:* I soften my gaze. I let attention spread. Thoughts = clouds.
- *What changed when space opened?*

Chapter 9 — The Four Stages: Step-by-Step Guide

This is the full, sequential exercise of the Fourfold Axis. It is best done in a quiet position, but the steps can be applied at any moment.

The Stance Behind the Steps

Before you begin the stages, remember: gentleness is not optional — it is the method itself. Every time you return without criticism, every time you accept distraction as part of the process — you practice kindness. Not as an idea, as an act.

Harsh self-criticism appears to engage the same threat-response circuits as external danger. The gentle return settles them. This is the road: not by fighting autopilot, but by giving it room to settle.

Treat yourself the way you would treat a friend who is struggling.

Stage 1 — Feel the Earth (Grounding)

- Sit or stand comfortably. Back upright but not tight.
- Feel the points of contact: soles, back against the seat.
- Let the weight sink into the earth.
- With each exhale, relax neck, jaw, shoulders.
- **Aim:** To feel the vertical axis — your base.

Stage 2 — Feel the Breath (Regulation)

- Close or half-close your eyes.
- Feel the path: inhale through the nose → lungs → belly, exhale in reverse.
- In tension: exhale slowly through the mouth, as if blowing out a candle.
- **Aim:** A natural, uninterrupted rhythm — calming of the nervous system.

Stage 3 — Focus Forward (Concentration)

- Open your eyes. Choose a quiet point in front of you.
- Look at it with a soft, steady gaze.
- If thoughts come: recognize → label → return gently.
- **Aim:** Training attention to stabilize.

Stage 4 — Open into Space (Open Awareness)

- Soften the gaze. Open peripheral vision.
- See the whole visual field: right, left, up, down.
- Feel all at once: body, breath, earth, sky.
- **Aim:** An immediate sense of presence, without words or effort.

In the app: the whole practice with guidance and the structured program step by step · the practice space with all the exercises.

Reflection: Which stage feels most natural to me? Where do I struggle most?

Chapter 10 — The Background: Science and Wisdom

This guide is not merely a book of exercises. For the neurodivergent mind — which is not satisfied with "do it because I say so" — it tries to show both the **how** (neuroscience), the **what** (practice), and the **why** (contemplative tradition). It does not ask for trust; it builds it through understanding.

Part A: The Scientific Foundation

The philosophy of the research. Classic mindfulness techniques can bring anxiety or "freezing" to neurodivergent people, because they often ask for immediate stillness and passive observation. This method starts from the other end: from the body upward (somatic, bottom-up) — first the nervous system is regulated, then observation comes.

Body — Grounding & Gravity. The brain continually computes gravity and the body's relationship to the ground, with the cerebellum playing a central role in this computation. In practice, turning attention to gravity and the points of support gives the nervous system a stable, familiar reference — a sense of "here" that needs no thought.

Source: Mackrour et al. (2019). Current Biology. DOI: 10.1016/j.cub.2019.07.006

Breath — The Vagus Nerve. The slow, prolonged exhale activates the "ventral" side of the vagus nerve, which is associated with states of calm and safety. You do not need to "convince" yourself that you are safe; in experience, the exhale sends the signal on its own.

Source: Porges (1995/2011). Psychophysiology. DOI: 10.1111/j.1469-8986.1995.tb03320.x

Attention — A Quiet DMN. The Default Mode Network (DMN) is associated with mind-wandering, rumination, and self-criticism, and is

often overactive in neurodivergent brains. Farb and colleagues showed that the shift from "narrative" to direct, experiential attention (what I feel now) is associated with reduced DMN activity. Labeling and returning to sensation are exactly this shift.

Source: Farb et al. (2007). Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience. DOI: 10.1093/scan/nsm030

Space — Open Awareness. Open, wide awareness is associated with increased synchronization of Alpha and Gamma brainwaves — a pattern observed in experienced meditators. In experience, this feels like "unsticking" from narrow hyperfocus: less exhaustion, more spaciousness.

Source: Lutz, Davidson et al. (2004). PNAS. DOI: 10.1073/pnas.0407401101

That these change with repetition rests on **neuroplasticity** — the brain's ability to reorganize itself through practice.

Further studies (title & DOI):

- Effectiveness in adult ADHD — Kim & Jung (2025). Medicine. DOI: 10.1097/md.00000000000044308
- Neurobiology & neuroplasticity of mindfulness — Calderone et al. (2024). Biomedicines. DOI: 10.3390/biomedicines12112613
- DMN connectivity & meditation — Brewer et al. (2011). PNAS. DOI: 10.1073/pnas.1112029108
- 8-week program specifically for ADHD — Zylowska et al. (2008). Journal of Attention Disorders. DOI: 10.1177/1087054707308502
- Hyperfocus as "all or nothing" regulation — Ashinoff & Abu-Akel (2019). Psychological Research. DOI: 10.1007/s00426-019-01245-8
- Peripheral vision & soft gaze — Vater et al. (2022). Psychonomic Bulletin & Review. DOI: 10.3758/s13423-022-02117-w

- Ecological perception & the ground — Gibson (1979/2014). Psychology Press. DOI: 10.4324/9781315740218
- Brainwave entrainment (binaural) — Lane et al. (1998). Physiology & Behavior. DOI: 10.1016/S0031-9384(97)00436-8

Part B: The Spiritual Background

Mahāsatipaṭṭhāna Sutta. The Four Foundations of Mindfulness (Body, Feelings, Mind, Mental Phenomena) correspond directly to the four stages of our method.

Dzogchen. Traditions such as Dzogchen speak of recognizing the "open space" of consciousness, in which thoughts and emotions appear and disappear without confining us.

Sufism. Sufism reminds us of the importance of grounding and of the heart as center — the connection of spirit and body.

Conclusion: *Science and spirituality agree — balance begins in the body, is regulated by the breath, is stabilized by attention, and expands into a sense of vastness.*

Resources & Further Reading

- Open Focus — <<https://openfocus.com/home/>>
- Short Moments of Open Intelligence — <<https://www.holybooks.com/wp-content/uploads/Short-Moments-of-Open-Intelligence.pdf>>
- LaMa Lena — Dzogchen — <<https://lamalenateachings.com/>>
- Merigar — International Dzogchen Community — <<https://www.merigar.it/en/dzogchen-community/>>
- Sufism — <<https://sufi.gr/>>

Part 3 — The 8-Week Program

This is the complete, guided program — the practical road built on the theory of the previous parts. It is organized around the four axes, two weeks each (Body, Breath, Attention, Space), with one small practice a day. There is no rush and no "failure" — even distraction is part of the learning.

The golden rule: before every exercise, begin with a few seconds of grounding in the body.

Body / Earth

Week 1 — Body / Earth: Gravity & Axis

Day 1 — Gravity vs. "Autopilot"

Anywhere · 1 second, many times a day

Our method is a method of "self-relaxation," not of pressured self-concentration. There is no rush, no force, no "failure" — everything is learning, even distraction.

The Default Mode Network (DMN) — the brain's "autopilot" — is associated with mind-wandering. Today we run an experiment: we feel gravity in order to restore bodily sensation and activate the proprioceptive center. The "autopilot" does not stop for good with gravity alone (that requires open awareness), but it is the first step in returning to the Now.

Exercise — Feel Gravity:

- During the day, remember:
- Stop what you are doing for 1 second.
- Simply feel the weight of your body "falling."
- Return gently, without criticism, if you drift.

Breath: No requirement — We do no breathing exercise today. We simply observe.

Reflection: How did I feel when I reactivated the sense of gravity?

★ **Gravity returns the body to the present. It is the first anchor.**

Day 2 — The Axis as Safety

Anywhere · 1 second, many times a day

We are building a relaxed presence. The more tense you are, the more closed your attention and your sense of the space around you.

Today we add the "axis." Besides the gravity that pulls you down, there is an imaginary vertical line that keeps you upright. This axis is your safety. It keeps you steady and open, without needing to clench.

Exercise — 1-Second Pause:

- When you remember, during the day:
- Take a pause (1 second).
- Feel gravity pulling you down.
- Feel the vertical axis keeping you upright and relaxed.

Breath: Natural Breath — Let your body breathe as it wishes.

Reflection: Could I feel this "imaginary line" within me without clenching?

★ **Your axis keeps you upright and aligned, providing structure without tension.**

Day 3 — Feel the Soles

Anywhere · 2 seconds

Our soles are the main radar of communication with the ground. For many neurodivergent people, contact with the floor offers enormous safety.

Today, the experiment centers on the point of contact.

Exercise — Contact with the Ground:

- During the day, take a pause.

- Feel the contact of the soles with your shoes or the floor.
- Is the footing stable?
- 1-2 seconds are enough.
- Continue your day.

Breath: Breath (5-5 rhythm) — Optional: You can begin 5-5 breathing (Inhale 5, Exhale 5) only if it feels comfortable.

Reflection: Did I feel more grounded when I noticed my soles?

★ The ground is always there to support you.

Day 4 — Feet and Axis

Anywhere · 5 minutes

We join the sensation of the soles with the axis we learned on Day 2. Imagine that the axis begins at the soles and rises straight up.

Exercise — Connecting Feet and Axis:

- Stop for a moment (standing or seated).
- Feel your soles.
- Let your attention rise gradually up the legs.
- Feel how the legs connect to the axis of the torso.

Breath: Calm Breath — If you wish, keep the 5-5 rhythm.

Reflection: Can I feel my legs as the foundations of the axis?

★ The heavier the foundations, the lighter the torso.

Day 5 — Feet, Axis & Pelvis

A quiet place · 5 minutes

The pelvis is the body's center of gravity. It is the "pot" in which your axis takes root.

Today we bring our attention to the region of the pelvis.

Exercise — The Center of Gravity:

- Sit comfortably or stand upright.
- Feel soles and legs.
- Raise your attention to the pelvis. Feel its weight if you are seated.
- Feel how your axis grows up through it.

Breath: 5-5 with Pelvic Awareness — Take an inhale of 5" and feel the air descend all the way to the pelvis. Exhale 5".

Reflection: Is the pelvis tight or relaxed?

★ **The pelvis is our point of safety and balance.**

Day 6 — Head, Arms, Legs, Axis

A quiet place · 5 minutes

Now the map of the body spreads out. Until now we had legs, pelvis, and axis. Today we add the arms and the head.

Everything connects to the central axis.

Exercise — Expanding into Space:

- Soles, legs, pelvis, axis.
- Add the arms: feel their weight hanging.
- Add the head: it balances perfectly on the axis.
- Feel the whole body as one unified, connected whole.

Breath: 5-5 Breath — Keep the steady rhythm of balance.

Reflection: Which part of the body did I feel least clearly?

★ **When we feel the whole body, the brain feels greater safety.**

Day 7 — Mindful Walking (Slow Walking)

In an open space or hallway · 10 minutes

Stability is not stillness. It is keeping our center (the axis) while we move through space.

Today we bring mindfulness to a very slow walk.

Exercise — Walking with Awareness:

- Begin to walk very slowly.
- Feel each phase of the step: heel - sole - toes.
- Keep awareness of your axis, your arms, and your head.
- Feel how the balance transfers.

Breath: Natural Rhythm — Connect the breath with the steps. E.g., Inhale 2 steps, Exhale 2 steps.

Reflection: Did I feel more stable walking slowly?

★ **Movement without rush deeply soothes the nervous system.**

Week 2 — Body / Earth: Deeper Realization

Day 1 — Scan of All Points & Pause

A quiet place · 10 minutes

The second week begins with a review (scan) of the tools of the first week: Gravity, Axis, Soles, Pelvis, Arms, Head.

We pause and observe.

Exercise — Safety Body Scan:

- Stand or sit comfortably.
- Begin from the soles - feel them. Move up gradually.
- Feel knees, pelvis, the torso (axis).
- Feel the shoulders, the arms (their weight).
- Feel the neck and the head.
- Take a 30-second pause, feeling the "whole."

Breath: 5-5 Breath — Keep a gentle 5-5 rhythm during the scan.

Reflection: Is there a point that "attracts" my attention more?

★ Clear mapping of the body reduces the sense of anxiety.

Day 2 — Releasing the Shoulders & Axis

Anywhere · 5 minutes

Today we focus on a point that holds a lot of tension: the shoulders. We learn to give their weight to gravity, while keeping the central axis strong.

Exercise — Letting Go of Tension (Shoulders):

- Stand or sit with the axis aligned.
- Bring attention to your shoulders. Feel how you hold them.
- With an exhale, simply let them drop, giving their weight to the earth.
- The axis stays tall, the shoulders heavily grounded.

Breath: Exhale of Release — Each time you exhale, the shoulders grow heavier by a fraction.

Reflection: How much tension was I holding in my shoulders without knowing?

★ **True stability (axis) needs no clenching.**

Day 3 — Releasing the Neck & Axis

Anywhere · 5 minutes

We continue the release from top to bottom. The neck supports the head on the axis.

Exercise — Head & Neck:

- Find the central axis.
- Bring attention to the neck. Feel that the head balances without effort.
- Make small, almost imperceptible movements right and left to "unlock" the neck.
- Give the weight to gravity.

Breath: Calm Breath — The rhythm of your breath (5-5) supports the axis.

Reflection: Did my neck soften at all?

★ **Focus does not have to be static.**

Day 4 — Pelvis, Belly, Scan (Soles-Head)

A quiet place · 10 minutes

Today the scan is reinforced by observing the belly. For many people, the belly is the "mirror" of tension.

Exercise — Scan with Focus on the Center:

- Begin the scan from the soles upward.
- When you reach the pelvis, stay there.
- Bring attention to the belly. Is it tight? Let it "fall," fully relax (soft belly).
- Continue the scan to chest, arms, head.

Breath: Belly Breathing (Soft Belly) — Inhale: the belly gently rises. Exhale: the belly falls.

Reflection: Did I manage to let my belly relax, instead of holding it "in"?

★ A soft belly immediately sends a signal of "safety" to the brain (via the Vagus nerve).

Day 5 — Scan & Balance

A quiet place · 10 minutes

Today we focus on the large joints as we scan the body: Knees, Pelvis, and how these regulate our balance.

Exercise — Joints & Balance:

- Stand upright. Scan from soles to pelvis.
- Stop at the knees: are they over-extended (too straight/locked)? Bend them SLIGHTLY (micro-bend).
- Stop at the pelvis: find the center of balance.
- Feel the safety (belly relaxed).

Breath: 5-5 Breath — Keep the rhythm (or 4-7-8 if it feels better, for relaxation).

Reflection: Did I feel the difference in "unlocked" knees?

★ When we "unlock" the knees, we allow energy and weight to flow into the earth.

Day 6 — Axis & Mindful Walking

Outdoors or at home · 10 minutes

Today we join movement with stillness. The test of mindfulness is to keep the sense of the "center" (axis) in all conditions.

Exercise — Movement and Pause:

- Begin with slow Mindful Walking (3 minutes).
- Stop abruptly. Feel the soles & the axis (1 minute).
- Feel the grounding and find your center again.
- Return to walking.
- Experiment with different walking speeds.

Breath: Rhythmic Breath — Try to keep your breath unaffected by the changes in movement.

Reflection: How easy was it to find my balance right after walking?

★ The axis exists both in movement and in stillness.

Day 7 — Metronome & Slow Walking

A quiet place / Hallway · 10 minutes

The last day of the Body section. We integrate RHYTHM. Rhythm is deeply regulating and important for autistic and ADHD people.

Exercise — Movement with Rhythm / Metronome:

- Use an imaginary or real metronome (or the beats from our "Binaural Beats").

- Walk in rhythm to the tempo. 1, 2, 1, 2. (3 minutes)
- Stop and find the axis. (1 minute)
- Feel the rhythm (metronome) beating within you while you are still.
- Repeat, letting the body follow freely.

Breath: Breath in Rhythm — Match the breath to the beats/steps (e.g., 2 steps in, 2 out).

Reflection: How did my nervous system feel the rhythm?

★ Rhythm gives the brain "prediction," and prediction brings calm.

Breath / Sky

Week 3 — Breath / Sky: The Current of Life

Day 1 — Introduction to the Breath

Anywhere · 5 minutes

From here on, every day we remember the golden rule: **we begin with a short grounding for a few seconds** before any exercise.

Today we simply read the chapter on the breath. The breath is our anchor.

Exercise — Observation without intervention:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Simply observe: how are you breathing at this moment?
- Do not try to change it.
- We keep only the awareness.

Breath: Natural Breath — No intervention.

Reflection: Did my breath change the moment I gave it attention?

★ **Observation by itself is an act of care.**

Day 2 — Inner Touch at the Nostrils

A quiet place · 5 minutes

The breath offers an "inner touch." We feel the air touching us from within.

Today the point of focus is the nostrils, as the air enters and leaves.

Exercise — Focus on the Nostrils:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Bring your attention to your nostrils.
- At exactly which point do you feel the air?
- During the day, take small pauses and recall this sensation.

Breath: Natural Flow — Feel the coolness of the inhale and the warmth of the exhale.

Reflection: Can I feel the air more strongly in the right or the left nostril?

★ Inner touch is the most direct way to ground ourselves in the body.

Day 3 — Throat & Rhythmic Breath

A quiet place · 5-10 minutes

We move attention a little lower, to the throat. There, where the air passes and creates a sound. Today we experiment with two rhythms.

Exercise — Observation at the Throat & Rhythms:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Feel the breath passing through your throat.
- Begin with a 5-5 rhythm (Inhale 5, Exhale 5).
- Then try 4-2-7 (Inhale 4, Hold 2, Exhale 7).
- See which rhythm calms you more.

Breath: 5-5 and 4-2-7 — Rhythm immediately changes the function of our control center.

Reflection: Which of the two rhythms felt more natural to me?

★ Different rhythms work differently in our nervous system.

Day 4 — The Belly That Rises and Falls

A quiet place · 5 minutes

We descend to the base of the breath: the belly. When the belly "rises and falls" freely, the body knows it is safe.

Exercise — Belly Breathing:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Rest one hand on the belly.
- Observe the belly filling (inhale).
- At the end, observe the exhale exclusively, as the belly "empties."

Breath: Exhale from the belly — Emphasize how the belly relaxes as the air empties out.

Reflection: Was it easy to breathe by unlocking my belly?

★ A soft belly lets the deep breath heal us.

Day 5 — The Path: Nose - Throat - Lungs

A quiet place · 5 minutes

Today we join the pieces. The air is a current that travels within us.

Exercise — Tracking the Path:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Track a full inhale.
- Nose -> Throat -> Lungs.
- Track the return during the exhale.

Breath: Circular Awareness — Your attention travels along with the air.

Reflection: Could I follow the air along its whole path?

★ **When the mind travels with the breath, it has no room for anxious thoughts.**

Day 6 — Whole Breath and Pauses

Anywhere · 5 minutes

We read the chapter on pauses. Between the inhale and the exhale there is a small gap. A natural "pause." That is where the quiet lives.

Exercise — Observing the Pauses:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Do a whole-body observation (the entire body breathes).
- Notice the small pause at the end of the inhale before you exhale.
- Notice the small pause at the end of the exhale before you inhale again.
- Simply rest there during the day.

Breath: Whole Breath with Pauses — A quiet stop in the flow.

Reflection: How did I feel the moment of the pause?

★ **In the pause we expect nothing, we simply are.**

Day 7 — Opening the Chest & Breath

Open space · 10 minutes

We combine the breath with the movement of the body, in a simple way, to create more space.

Exercise — Opening with the Rhythm of the Breath:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- As you inhale, open the chest slightly and draw the shoulders back.
- As you exhale, relax completely, letting the body return to its neutral posture.
- Repeat several times at your own rhythm.

Breath: Synchronization — Opening = inhale. Relaxing = exhale.

Reflection: Could I synchronize the body with the breath?

★ **Movement without forcing makes the breath deeper and safer.**

Week 4 — Breath / Sky: Movement & Kindness**Day 1 — Review: Nostrils & 5-5**

A quiet place · 5 minutes

We begin the fourth week by blending the tools of the previous days. Today we recall the inner touch at the nostrils.

Exercise — Nostrils and Rhythm together:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Focus first on the nostrils.
- Apply a 5-5 rhythm (Inhale 5, Exhale 5) while staying there.
- Keep your attention on the inner touch.

Breath: 5-5 at the Nostrils — Circular keeping of attention.

Reflection: How easy was it to stay at the nostrils?

★ Repetition is the road for the nervous system to learn.

Day 2 — Review: Throat & 4-2-7

A quiet place · 5 minutes

We continue with the throat and the pause that allows deeper relaxation (rhythm 4-2-7).

Exercise — Throat with prolonged exhale:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Bring your awareness to the throat.
- Inhale 4 seconds, Hold 2.
- Exhale 7 seconds, feeling the air in the throat.

Breath: 4-2-7 Breath — We activate the system of calm.

Reflection: What happened in my body with the long exhale?

★ The longer exhale rhythm is one of the simplest and most reliable regulators.

Day 3 — Review: Belly & Pause Breathing

A quiet place · 5 minutes

We return to the center of gravity: the belly. When the belly "rises and falls" freely, the body feels safe.

Exercise — Belly and Pause:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Rest a hand on the belly. Feel it rising.
- At the end of the inhale (the rise), notice the natural pause.

- At the end of the exhale, notice the natural pause before you draw air again.

Breath: Pause at the Belly — The belly "rests" between the cycles.

Reflection: Did I manage to stay in the pause without anxiety?

★ In the pause lies the deepest trust.

Day 4 — Sounding Breath (Chanting)

A quiet place · 5 minutes

Producing sound (like humming) creates a vibration that massages the vagus nerve, calming the body.

It does not need to have any religious tone. Today we will use a note (e.g., "C") or simply the letter "A." If you have a mantra of your own from your tradition (optional), you may use it.

In the app: "Chanting & Resonance" (Humming) practices

Exercise — Vibration with the Sound "A":

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Take a calm inhale.
- Exhaling, make a low, prolonged "Aaah" or the note C.
- Feel the vibration in your throat and chest.
- Repeat for a few cycles.

Breath: Exhale with Sound — The sound naturally lengthens the exhale.

Reflection: Did something change in my body as I felt the vibration of the sound?

★ Sound is a tool of the nervous system. Vibration drives out tension.

Day 5 — Mindful Movement: Opening the Arms & Kindness

Open space · 5 minutes

We introduce a new Mindful Movement: opening the arms toward the sky and the heart. Here we add the intention of Kindness (Metta) toward all.

Exercise — Opening to the Universe:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- With the inhale, open your arms wide and upward (to the sky). Unfold the chest (heart).
- As you open, feel tenderness and kindness toward yourself and toward all.
- With the exhale, lower the arms gently to your sides.

Breath: Expanded Inhale — The chest opens, the heart "breathes."

Reflection: What feeling did opening the arms evoke?

★ The body's posture deeply affects our emotion and our intention.

Day 6 — Deepening: Opening to the Sky

Open space · 5 minutes

We repeat the same Mindful Movement, focusing even more on the sensation of the chest and the heart.

Exercise — The Center of the Heart:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).

- Begin the movement: arms open, heart opens.
- Think inwardly: "May I be well. May all be well" as you inhale from the chest.
- The movement becomes a prayer of kindness.

Breath: Breath from the Heart — The inhale as an opening.

Reflection: Was there any resistance to kindness within me?

★ Kindness is not just a thought, it is a bodily experience.

Day 7 — Completion: Body, Breath & Kindness

Open space · 10 minutes

Today the second axis is completed. We have connected body, breath, movement, and kindness.

As we have said, there are 10 mindful movements in total that we will use later (depending on the center) once we finish the weeks.

In the app: "Chanting & Resonance" (Humming) practices

Exercise — The Final Breathing Practice:

- Grounding in the body (10 seconds).
- Observation of rhythm (5-5) for 2 minutes.
- Mindful movement Bow (2 minutes).
- Opening the arms to the sky + Kindness (Metta) (2 minutes).
- Pause and observe the effect in the body (2 minutes).

Breath: Natural Breath as a Crowning — Close the practice by letting it all go.

Reflection: How do I feel my body and my breath after 4 weeks?

★ You have already built a strong base of self-regulation.

Attention / Fire

Week 5 — Attention / Fire: Focus and Light

Day 1 — Introduction to Attention

Anywhere · A few minutes

In every exercise: **first we feel our axis, gravity, and our breath. We regulate it gently.** This is our base.

Reading: Our attention is the lens that illuminates our experience.

Exercise — Gazing for 7":

- Grounding, axis, breath. (30 seconds)
- During the day, take small pauses.
- Look steadily at any object for 7 seconds.
- Return to what you were doing.

Breath: Gentle Observation 7" — Keep the breath calm while you observe.

Reflection: What did I see in those 7 seconds?

★ **Seven seconds of attention are enough to break the day's autopilot.**

Day 2 — Alternating Attention

Anywhere · 5 minutes

We keep sharpening the "lens" of attention, moving our focus consciously. The movement of the gaze rests the nervous system.

Exercise — Right - Left:

- Grounding, axis, breath.
- Choose an object on your right and one on your left.
- Look at the right one with focus. Feel your breath.
- Move your gaze to the left one. Feel your breath.
- Make the switch slowly, a few times.

Breath: Attention and Rhythm — Keep the rhythm (e.g., 5-5) during the switch.

Reflection: Did anything change in the sensation of the body as I moved my focus?

★ **When you direct your attention consciously, you regain control.**

Day 3 — Visual Anchor

A quiet place · 5 minutes

If you imagine your visual field as a camera, today you focus the "camera" exactly at eye level. It is your anchor.

Exercise — Anchor at the Eyes:

- Grounding, axis, gentle breath.
- Find a point exactly at eye level.
- Stay there. The gaze neither rises nor falls.
- Let your attention become one with the point.

Breath: Steady Anchor — The steadiness of the gaze calms the thinking.

Reflection: How easy was it not to move my "camera" (my gaze)?

★ A steady point of reference creates inner stability.

Day 4 — Soles, Breath, Object

Anywhere · 5 minutes

We connect three levels of attention on one thread: the Earth (soles), the Air (breath), and Space (object).

Exercise — Triple Focus:

- Begin with grounding (feel the soles).
- Observe the breath and regulate it.
- Focus on an object.
- Now try to feel all three at once: Soles - Breath - Object.

Breath: Synchronizing Attention — We widen the field of attention without losing our center.

Reflection: Can I hold three things in my attention at once?

★ The capacity of your consciousness is greater than you think.

Day 5 — Closed and Open Attention

Throughout the day · Small pauses

Our attention has a zoom. Sometimes it centers (zoom in - closed) and sometimes it sees the whole field (zoom out - open).

Exercise — Switching the Lens:

- At moments during the day: grounding, breath.
- Focus on a small point (Closed Attention).
- Soften the gaze, see the whole space peripherally (Open Attention).
- Stay in the open attention for a few seconds.

Breath: Zoom in / Zoom out — Breath in concentration and breath in expansion.

Reflection: When do I feel more comfortable? In closed or in open attention?

★ **Fear narrows the gaze. Calm opens it.**

Day 6 — Stability of 12 Seconds

A quiet place · 5 minutes

We raise the difficulty of the first day. 12 seconds are enough to change your inner state.

Exercise — The 12" Anchor:

- Grounding, axis, gentle breath.
- Body: feel the body in space.
- Breath: observe the rhythm.
- Focus on a point STEADILY for 12 seconds.
- Do not let the eyes or the mind leave until the 12" have passed.

Breath: 5-5 in Stability — 12" means a little more than one breath cycle.

Reflection: Did the 12 seconds feel long or short?

★ **A few seconds of clear presence erase hours of absence.**

Day 7 — From the Point to the Space

Anywhere · 5 minutes

We combine the tools: first the sharp focus (which brings presence), then the widening (which brings rest).

Exercise — Melting the Lens:

- Grounding, axis, gentle breath.
- Lock attention onto ONE point.
- Feel the sharpness of your gaze.
- Slowly begin to see the space AROUND the point.
- Allow your attention to become open and peripheral.

Breath: Breath of Release — From control to acceptance.

Reflection: How did I feel the moment the lens "opened"?

★ You do not need to hold the world up alone. Space holds you.

Week 6 — Attention / Fire: Establishing Calm**Day 1 — Closed and Open Attention**

A quiet place · 10 minutes

We enter Week 6; our aim is consolidation. We begin by reinforcing the transition from the one thing (object) to the whole.

Exercise — Transition to Space:

- Always: grounding, breath, axis.
- Lock attention onto an object across from you.
- Stay there for a while.
- Abruptly relax the focus (open attention) and simply observe the whole scene.
- Repeat three times.

Breath: Rhythm of Transition — Concentration in the closed, widening in the open.

Reflection: Is the switch from focus to relaxation easier now?

★ The ability to relax is just as useful as the ability to concentrate.

Day 2 — Thoughts as Objects (Calm)

A quiet place · 10 minutes

Imagine your mind as a visual field. Thoughts are simply objects (like clouds or bubbles) that enter this field and pass through. This practice cultivates Calm — steady observation without being carried away.

Exercise — Observing Thoughts:

- Grounding, axis, rhythmic breath.
- Close your eyes. Imagine the field of your mind.
- A thought comes. See it as an object.
- Do not hold it. See it cross the field of observation and leave.
- You remain the steady observer.

Breath: Breath of Calm — A steady base while the "objects" pass.

Reflection: Did I manage not to identify with any thought?

★ You are not your thoughts. You are the space in which they happen.

Day 3 — Establishing Calm

Daily life & Evening · 10 minutes

We enter a rhythm of consolidation. We apply what we have learned until it takes root. We introduce a new routine for the evening.

Exercise — 5-5 and Evening Routine:

- During the day: 5-5 breathing exercise (Inhale 5 / Exhale 5).
- Breath of calm (small pauses) whenever you need it.
- **Evening Routine:** "Settling, Slowing Down."
- Before sleep: grounding in bed, deep exhales, letting the day go.

Breath: 5-5 and Breath of Calm — The rhythm of stability.

Reflection: Did the evening routine help my sleep?

★ **Whatever is repeated becomes part of you.**

Day 4 — The Echo of the Past (Insight)

Mentally · 10 minutes

Through calm observation we begin to gain insight. As you sit and observe, the critical "echo of the past" often appears.

You see clearly the content of your consciousness and realize how it tries to control you from behind the scenes.

Exercise — Changing the Helmsman:

- When you observe a critical thought (the echo), recognize it.
- Do not fight it. Simply let it go, as "not useful."
- In its place, put presence (grounding) with kindness and openness.
- You change "helmsman": from the subconscious/turmoil, to conscious, open presence.

Breath: Breath of Acceptance — Inhale presence, exhale the "not useful."

Reflection: Could I see my "self-criticism" as a mere "echo" and not as truth?

★ You are now free to choose who governs your mind.

Day 5 — The Mental Mantra

Anywhere · 10 minutes

If the mind races too much into negative scenarios and it is hard to simply observe the thoughts, give it something to do.

Use a mental chant/mantra without any religious tone (e.g., a song lyric like "always look on the bright side of life," or something from your tradition if you wish). This occupies the mind without creating negative emotions in it.

Exercise — Replacing with a Mantra:

- When the mind gets trapped in a negative scenario:
- Grounding, axis, rhythmic breath.
- Begin to repeat mentally the phrase/mantra you chose.
- Each time the mind goes to the scenario, return gently to the mantra.

Breath: Rhythm with the Mantra — Connect the syllables of the phrase with your breath.

Reflection: Did the mantra help stop the negative scenario?

★ Often we cannot stop the mind, but we can give it a harmless occupation.

Day 6 — Presence Everywhere with Kindness

Anywhere · Continuous practice

The consistency of the last days bears fruit. "Open attention" becomes natural, always with the mark of simple kindness toward ourselves.

Exercise — The Effortless Anchor:

- During the day, without effort: recall the soles and a visual point.
- Your breath regulates itself often (5-5).
- If you drift, return gently, without criticism (self-compassion).
- Evening routine of surrender to sleep.

Breath: 5-5 as Second Nature — The rhythm finds itself on its own.

Reflection: Was I kinder to myself when I drifted today?

★ **Mindfulness is the return, not the absence of distraction.**

Day 7 — Completing the Consolidation

Anywhere · 15 minutes

We reach the end of the sixth week, where Attention, Space, and the new, open "Helmsman" of the mind have begun to take root day by day.

Exercise — Review and Routine:

- Grounding, axis, gravity.
- Breath of calm (rhythmic 5-5).
- Remember: closed (zoom in) and open attention (zoom out).
- Thoughts as passing objects (Calm and Insight).
- We end the week with the evening routine.

Breath: Regulation before Sleep — A day that closes in calm brings a clear morning.

Reflection: What was the most useful tool of these two weeks?

★ You do not need to push your mind. It is enough to let it rest in the open space.

Space / Water

Week 7 — Space / Water: Open Awareness

Day 1 — The 4 Centers & Sky

Anywhere / Outdoors · 5-10 minutes

From this week we join the 4 centers (Body, Breath, Attention, Space). We learn "Open Attention."

Every day: **Sky-gazing**. Take a little time to look at the sky and breathe through it.

Exercise — Sky-Gazing:

- Open your attention a little in the morning, at noon, and in the evening.
- A few times a day, look up at the sky.
- Take a deep breath, feeling the vast space.

Breath: Breath from the Sky — Imagine that you breathe from the vast space of the sky.

Reflection: Could I feel the open attention today?

★ **The sky is always there, behind the clouds.**

Day 2 — Open Attention 3 Times

Anywhere · A few minutes

We continue joining the 4 centers. Body, breath, attention, and space become one.

Practice open attention a little in the morning, a little at noon, and a little in the evening.

Exercise — Open Attention Routine:

- Morning: 1-2 minutes of open attention. Feel the 4 centers.
- Noon: 1-2 minutes of connection again.
- Evening: Relaxation and observation of the space.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: Did I remember to "open" my attention at these 3 moments?

★ Small reminders build a continuous state of presence.

Day 3 — Sky-Gazing & Unification

Anywhere / Outdoors · A few minutes

When you look at the sky, your eyes naturally open their peripheral vision. Your body grounds and the space allows your breath to be released.

Exercise — Unification:

- Feel the body (Gravity).
- Observe the breath.
- Focus the attention.
- Open into Space (Sky-Gazing).

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: How do I feel when I join all 4 centers?

★ You are not only the body, you are also the space that surrounds it.

Day 4 — Our Daily Routine

Anywhere · A few minutes

We consolidate our practice. Reading and practicing now means: Body, Breath, Space, Attention.

Sky-gazing. Open attention in the morning, at noon, and in the evening.

Exercise — Sky & 4 Centers:

- We establish a habit: Every morning, noon, evening.
- Awareness through the 4 centers at once.
- The Sky is the inspiration of space.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: Does open attention feel easier now?

★ Attention does not need clenching, it needs opening.

Day 5 — Instant Pause

Anywhere · 2-5 seconds

We enter the last 10 days of the program. In these days, beyond the basic practice (4 centers, sky-gazing, open attention 3x/day), we will use **micro-exercises of seconds**.

Exercise — Instant Pause (Short Moment):

- For 2-5 seconds, let your thoughts be exactly as they are.
- Do not try to change them, do not judge them.
- Simply rest in these few seconds.

- Do it several times today.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: Can a 3-second pause bring calm?

★ The pause is the door to the "Now."

Day 6 — The "Open Horizon"

Anywhere · A few seconds

We continue: Body, breath, attention, space. 3 times a day (morning, noon, evening) and sky-gazing.

Today's micro-exercise helps us not get stuck in thoughts. Contrary to what we believe, thoughts need our "closed" space to survive. When we open our mental field, thoughts dissolve on their own.

Exercise — The "Open Horizon":

- Imagine that your mind is the vast sky.
- Your thoughts are clouds passing by.
- Do not chase the clouds.
- Remain the sky.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: Did I manage not to follow a "cloud" (thought) today?

★ You do not need to clear the sky of clouds. The sky always has room.

Day 7 — Interrupting the Autopilot

During an activity · 3 seconds

Morning, noon, evening: Open attention and 4 centers. The sky is still your teacher for the sense of space.

Today we break the routine with small interruptions. Our mind's "autopilot" (the Default Mode Network we mentioned on the first day) feeds on ceaseless, breathless motion. When we cut it, our nervous system does a "reset."

Exercise — Interrupting the Autopilot:

- As you do something everyday (e.g., washing your hands).
- Take a 3-second pause.
- Simply feel that you "exist" without thinking of the next step.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: How many times did I recognize that I was on "autopilot"?

★ **The magic hides between the ordinary movements.**

Week 8 — Space / Water: The Infinite Cosmic Ocean (Tai Chi)

Day 1 — The Mind Is Not Broken

Anywhere · A few seconds

We enter the last week. The kindness we practiced is not an attempt to "become good," but the clearing of the "echoes" of rejection.

An old contemplative image says it simply: the mind is not broken — it is like muddy water. When you stop trying to control it, the "mud" settles on its own. The gold (your natural, innate kindness) was always there, beneath the storm.

Exercise — Space for Kindness:

- When you feel pressure or resistance, instead of "fighting" it...

- Simply accept the situation.
- Give it free space. Say: "Let it be exactly as it is."
- Watch the "mud" settle without any effort of yours.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: Did I feel relief in understanding that I am not "broken"?

★ **Resistance to emotion stirs the water. Acceptance clears it.**

Day 2 — The Six Points (Non-Effort)

Anywhere · A few seconds

Today we practice a classic set of six pointers, attributed to the 10th-century teacher Tilopa — the core of "non-effort" that calms the Mechanical Mind.

1. Do not recall (Past).
2. Do not imagine (Future).
3. Do not think (Inner monologue).
4. Do not examine (Analysis).
5. Do not control (Effort).
6. Rest (Let go).

Exercise — Non-Effort Test:

- In a moment of respite:
- Do not analyze whether you are doing well or badly.
- Do not even try to control your breath.
- Feel your axis and simply "Rest" in the Now.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: How did it feel to "not try" for a few seconds?

★ Sometimes the greatest effort is to stop trying.

Day 3 — The Elephant, the Monkey & the Lasso

Anywhere · A little while

The ancient tale of the meditating ascetic meets neurophysiology! Your mind is a wild black elephant (the Nervous System), driven by the monkey (the DMN). Your lasso is the "Gentle Return" of awareness.

You do not strike the elephant. You throw the lasso gently and bring it back. This is thought to strengthen the Insular Cortex of your brain.

Exercise — The Modern Ascetic:

- Take a pause for a few seconds.
- Observe the present moment.
- When the "elephant" runs off toward anxiety, gently throw the lasso of awareness.
- Return to the soles and the breath. That gentle return is the exercise itself — nothing more is asked of you.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: Did I feel the "gentle return" as a safe lasso rather than a punishment?

★ Every return of attention is a muscle growing stronger.

Day 4 — The Silence Behind the Sounds

Anywhere (even in noise) · A few seconds

Listen and open into space (morning, noon, evening). Today the micro-exercise uses hearing to find the emptiness (the openness).

As the ascetic feels the space beneath his tree, feel the space around you.

Exercise — The Silence behind the Sounds:

- As you hear any sound...
- Try at the same time to notice the silence that exists in the background.
- Feel the silence within which the sound is born.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: Is the silence always there, behind the noise?

★ **As the sky hosts the clouds, the silence hosts the sounds.**

Day 5 — Space within the Body

Anywhere · A few seconds

Continue with the daily practice (4 centers, sky-gazing). Today's micro-exercise turns inward: the same open space we find outside, we discover inside the body.

Exercise — Space within the Body:

- Take a small pause.
- Can you imagine that your chest is full of empty space?
- Imagine it as an empty, open vessel.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: How does the chest feel when it is not compressed?

★ **Spaciousness in the chest is the biological signature of calm.**

Day 6 — Giving Space to Others

In interactions · A few seconds

The same "open space" of kindness that we offer ourselves, we learn to offer to others around us too.

We let them exist effortlessly within the space, without trying to control them — exactly as we let go of our own "elephant."

Exercise — Spacious Kindness:

- In a conversation today...
- Feel your axis and your feet.
- Offer the other person an "empty space" of acceptance.
- Do not try to control them, simply let them exist.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: How did communication change when I stopped forcing things?

★ **The best relationship is one that lets both people breathe.**

Day 7 — Completing the Journey

Anywhere · Open

The last day of the program. Reading and practicing now means joining the 4 centers. Look at the sky. Keep an open attention, and remember: Your mind is not broken.

Exercise — Life like Sky / Effortless Presence:

- Open your eyes to the sky.
- Feel gravity in the body.

- Hear the silence behind the sounds.
- Feel that you are this Open Horizon.

Breath: Breath from the Sky

Reflection: What do I take away from these 8 weeks?

★ **We are not arriving somewhere. We are simply remembering how to be HERE.**

7-Day Practice Journal

Note each day what you practiced, how your experience was, and what you noticed. It does not need to be perfect — it only needs to be true.

Day 1 • Monday — Date: _____

☐ Body ☐ Breath ☐ Attention ☐ Space

What I noticed today:

Day 2 • Tuesday — Date: _____

☐ Body ☐ Breath ☐ Attention ☐ Space

What I noticed today:

Day 3 • Wednesday — Date: _____

☐ Body ☐ Breath ☐ Attention ☐ Space

What I noticed today:

Day 4 • Thursday — Date: _____

☐ Body ☐ Breath ☐ Attention ☐ Space

What I noticed today:

Day 5 • Friday — Date: _____

☐ Body ☐ Breath ☐ Attention ☐ Space

What I noticed today:

Day 6 • Saturday — Date: _____

☐ Body ☐ Breath ☐ Attention ☐ Space

What I noticed today:

Day 7 • Sunday — Date: _____

☐ Body ☐ Breath ☐ Attention ☐ Space

What I noticed today:

Appendix — The Rabbit Hole

The "Rabbit Hole" is a collection of optional, deeper texts within the app — contemplative and scientific extensions of the method, for anyone who wants to go further. They are all free. Below, organized by chapter.

Body (Ch. 1)

- **The Veils of Being** — the Matryoshka allegory: five veils, from the physical body to pure consciousness.

Breath (Ch. 2)

- **Learning to Ride the Wind** — the breath as a wind you accompany, not control.
- **The Lute String and the Vagus Nerve** — polyvagal theory and the middle way of the nervous system (also relevant to Ch. 7).

Attention (Ch. 3)

- **The Soft Gaze: A Door That Does Not Lock** — how peripheral vision and open hearing regulate the nervous system.

Space (Ch. 4)

- **The Wave Is Not the Sea — Until It Lets Go** — the distinction between mindfulness ($\triangle$) and awareness (∞).
- **You Are the Path: The Map, the Territory & the Axis** — map and territory, and the entry into the now through the axis.
- **The Seething Void** — the quantum void and awareness.

The Neurodivergent Mind (Ch. 5)

- **The Truth Behind the Labels: Plato's Cave** — the allegory of the cave through the lens of neurodivergence.
- **The Goose Is Out** — the koan of the goose and masking.
- **Never by Force** — why pressure in practice brings the opposite; the art of the effortless return (the thread of kindness).

Stages & Tradition (Ch. 9–10)

- **Dzogchen: The Great Perfection** — an introduction to effortless awareness.
- **The Nature of Mind & The Release of Tension** — nature of mind, Trekchö, and neuroscience.
- **The Forces of the Cosmos, the Axes of the Mind** — the elements/forces and the four axes.

About the App Itself

- **What Does Sandbox Mean?** — the framing of the "safe space for practice."

Epilogue

This road has no end. It is a way of standing within life, consciously choosing acceptance at every step.

Every moment can become a small return to gentleness and openness.

Mindfulness, in the end, is remembering that within you there already exists an open space that holds you as you are.

This space asks for nothing and rejects nothing — it simply reminds you that you are present, alive, and whole.

Keep returning. Consistency in small doses is your own greatest act of care.